

## HURRICANES

The Caribbean islands can be devastated by hurricanes between May and October each year. These powerful and damaging storms occur when a normal storm builds up energy as it moves across the Atlantic Ocean. Eventually, violent winds and torrential rain are released on the islands.



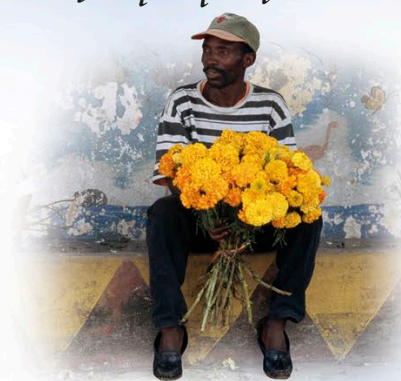
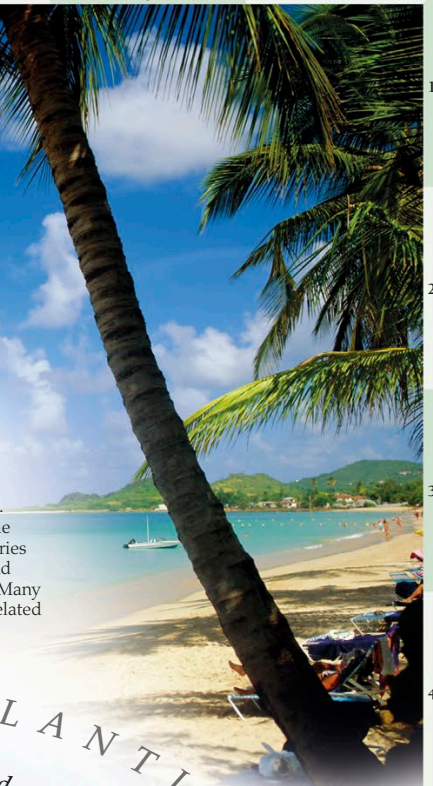
## FAMILY LIFE

Family is very important here, and is usually the center of everyday life. Some Caribbean people migrated to other countries, such as the UK, but return when they retire—often bringing considerable money back with them.



## TROPICAL ISLES

White sands and warm seas attract vast numbers of visitors to these islands. Tourism is important to the economies of many countries including the Bahamas and the Dominican Republic. Many people work in tourism-related jobs, such as in hotels.



Haitian man selling flowers

## HAITI

Haiti was the first Caribbean country to become independent. However, political unrest, combined with poor soil and natural disasters, have made Haiti one of the poorest countries in the world. Health care and sanitation levels are poor and, as a result, life expectancy is low.



## A TIME TO CELEBRATE

The celebration of Diwali (Hindu), Eid ul-Fitr (Muslim), and Christmas (Christian) reflect the varied religions of people in Trinidad and Tobago. The woman above is dressed for Carnival in Port of Spain to mark the beginning of the Christian season of Lent.